



1 MAYA CODEX

2 AZTEC LIP ORNAMENT



6 JADE VAMPIRE BAT MOSAIC MASK



7 CARVED STONE FROM TEMPLO MAYOR



8 GOLD NOSE PLUG



11 BALL MARKER



12 FEATHER SHIELD

Aztec to Inca

A highly sophisticated level of craftsmanship is evident in the decorative and sacrificial objects crafted by the ancient civilizations of Meso- and South America, from the Aztecs, Toltec, and Mayan peoples of Mexico to the Inca and Chimú of Peru.

1 Maya codex (painted book) showing drawings of five gods and hieroglyphics. It was read from top to bottom and left to right. 2 Aztec lip ornament in the shape of an eagle head with bangles hanging from the underside of its open beak. 3 Aztec labret (lip ornament) made by the Mixtecs. These ornaments were inserted through a hole pierced through the skin below the bottom lip. 4 Toltec mask inlaid with mother of pearl from the Toltec city of Tula, 40 miles (65 km) northwest of modern-day Mexico City. It represents a coyote warrior. 5 Toltec warrior carved from stone and painted in battle dress. Its arms are raised to hold an altar or shrine. 6 Zapotec vampire bat mosaic mask carved of 25 pieces of jade, with yellow eyes made of shell. 7 Carved round stone found at Templo Mayor, Mexico City, showing the separated limbs, head, and torso of the Aztec goddess Coyolxauhqui. 8 Mixtec nose plug made of hammered gold. Such nose plugs were placed

above the top lip. 9 Peruvian fan made from macaw feathers, with a handle of braided brown wool. 10 Aztec priest's sacrificial chert (stone) knife with a carved jaguar handle. 11 Maya ball marker, consisting of a disk with a whorled emblem on top of a pillar. It was used for ball-court games, which were played by all Mesoamericans. 12 Aztec feather shield, stretched with spotted jaguar skin and decorated with strings of feathers. All Aztec warriors carried a feather shield. 13 Chimú portrait beaker from Peru made of beaten silver. This may have been a portrait of a real person and used for ceremonial purposes. 14 Inca gold ornamental belt made up of rectangular sections. 15 Ornamental Maya incense burner in the form of Chaac (Maya god of rain) wearing an elaborate headdress. 16 Gold necklace found in the Basin of Mexico. 17 Aztec funerary urn made of clay, found at Templo Mayor, Mexico City, depicting a bearded god.



14 BELT ORNAMENT